

World Religions 30
Assignment Booklet #2
Chapter 2: Aboriginal Spirituality

Name: _____

Part One: Multiple-Choice Items

Read each item carefully and decide which choice best completes the statement or answers the question. Type the letter of your choice in the blank space before the item. (20 marks).

_____	1. Aboriginal spirituality is best described as A. a faith without a single founder B. a religion with one universal creed C. only a political movement D. a purely scientific theory
_____	2. One important way teachings are passed from one generation to the next is through A. oral tradition B. laboratory experiments C. census records D. party manifestos
_____	3. Wampum belts have often been used to A. record history and sacred agreements B. replace every spoken story C. identify military rank D. measure farmland
_____	4. Many creation stories are important because they A. carry spiritual meaning and identity B. eliminate all ceremony C. prove one scientific theory D. deny any link to land
_____	5. A worldview that stresses respect for land and living things most clearly reflects A. interconnection B. consumerism C. isolationism D. secularism
_____	6. Elders are often especially valued because they A. carry wisdom and experience B. replace every community leader C. reject tradition D. oppose ceremony
_____	7. The circle commonly symbolizes A. balance and wholeness B. military conquest C. economic class D. private property
_____	8. Smudging is generally associated with A. cleansing and prayer B. punishment C. trading goods D. taxation
_____	9. A sweat lodge ceremony is most closely associated with A. purification and renewal B. census taking C. land surveying D. political voting
_____	10. A vision quest traditionally seeks A. guidance and insight B. land ownership C. military status D. legal authority
_____	11. Sacred stories are important because they

	A. transmit worldview and values B. forbid all questioning C. replace every ritual D. only entertain children
_____	12. Aboriginal spirituality most often emphasizes A. harmony with creation B. total separation from nature C. rejection of community D. worship only once a week
_____	13. Which item would most likely be treated with reverence? A. land used for ceremony B. any random object C. only money D. only printed creeds
_____	14. Colonization often harmed Indigenous spiritual life by A. suppressing ceremonies B. protecting every practice C. increasing access to sacred land D. removing all prejudice
_____	15. The medicine wheel is commonly used to express A. balance and relationship B. military strategy C. legal punishment D. industrial output
_____	16. Which statement best reflects many Indigenous traditions? A. spirituality is lived daily B. spirituality is unrelated to ethics C. spirituality rejects storytelling D. spirituality exists only in temples
_____	17. An artifact highlighted in the chapter as a sign of long continuity is A. wampum B. a rosary C. a torii gate D. a stupa
_____	18. Respect for ancestors, community, and land would best fit A. Aboriginal spirituality B. industrial materialism C. atheist positivism D. imperial nationalism
_____	19. One reason creation stories matter is that they A. connect people to identity and place B. erase all diversity among nations C. eliminate ceremony D. turn history into science
_____	20. A person studying Aboriginal spirituality respectfully should first A. listen carefully to Indigenous voices B. assume all nations are identical C. treat ceremonies as entertainment D. focus on stereotypes

Part Two: Matching

Choose the letter of the term that best describes the concept or completes the sentence. Terms may be used more than once, and not all terms will be used. Enter the letter of the term into the blank space beside each statement. (15 marks).

Answer	Statement	Terms
_____	1. A sacred account that explains origins and carries spiritual meaning.	A. creation story B. elder C. oral tradition D. wampum E. land F. circle G. medicine wheel H. smudging I. sweat lodge J. vision quest K. respect L. interconnection M. ceremony N. community O. ancestor
_____	2. A respected keeper of wisdom, memory, and guidance within a community.	
_____	3. The passing on of teachings through spoken word, story, song, and example.	
_____	4. Belts of shell beads used to preserve memory, agreements, and history.	
_____	5. More than physical space; a source of identity, relationship, and sacred meaning.	
_____	6. A symbol often used to express wholeness, continuity, and balance.	
_____	7. A teaching symbol that can express balance, relationship, and the cycles of life.	
_____	8. A practice of spiritual cleansing often using sacred medicines.	
_____	9. A ceremony commonly associated with purification, prayer, and renewal.	
_____	10. A spiritually focused search for guidance and insight.	
_____	11. A core attitude shown toward people, ancestors, land, and living things.	
_____	12. The idea that life is linked and that relationships matter deeply.	
_____	13. A structured spiritual act that expresses belief and community values.	
_____	14. The group within which identity, responsibility, and tradition are often lived out.	

_____	15. A forebear whose memory and presence may remain spiritually significant.	
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Part Three: True or False

Read each statement carefully and decide if it is true or false. Type T or F in each blank beside the statement to indicate your choice for each. (15 marks).

_____	1. Aboriginal spirituality can usually be reduced to one founder and one exact creed.
_____	2. Creation stories can carry spiritual truth and cultural memory.
_____	3. Wampum may preserve agreements and historical memory.
_____	4. Elders are unimportant to the transmission of teachings.
_____	5. Many Indigenous worldviews connect spirituality with the land.
_____	6. The circle can symbolize balance and continuity.
_____	7. Smudging is unrelated to prayer or cleansing.
_____	8. A vision quest is traditionally connected with seeking guidance.
_____	9. Community has no important place in Aboriginal spirituality.
_____	10. Colonization had little or no effect on Indigenous ceremonies.
_____	11. Treating all Indigenous nations as though they share one identical religion is accurate.
_____	12. Respect is often a central value in Aboriginal spirituality.
_____	13. Stories, symbols, and ceremony can all communicate belief.
_____	14. Aboriginal spirituality is usually isolated from everyday life.
_____	15. A respectful student should prefer Indigenous voices when possible.

Part Four: Written-Response Items

Respond to the following items on the lines below the items. Attach additional pages if you need more space. (48 marks).

1. In your own words, explain why Aboriginal spirituality is not usually tied to one founder or one universal creed. (4 marks)

2. Summarize the importance of creation stories in Aboriginal spirituality. (4 marks)

3. Explain two ways land functions as more than physical space within Aboriginal worldview. (4 marks)

4. Describe the roles of oral tradition and elders in passing on teachings. (4 marks)

5. What is wampum, and what does it show about memory and agreement? (4 marks)

6. Explain the symbolism of the circle or medicine wheel. (4 marks)

7. Describe one ceremonial practice such as smudging, a sweat lodge, or a vision quest, and explain its purpose. (4 marks)

8. Explain how respect and interconnection shape relationships with people, animals, and the natural world. (4 marks)

9. How can community gatherings strengthen spiritual identity? Give two examples. (4 marks)

10. Describe one way colonization interfered with Indigenous spiritual practices. (4 marks)

11. Suggest two guidelines for studying Aboriginal spirituality respectfully in school or online. (4 marks)

12. Explain why it is inaccurate to treat all Indigenous nations as though they share one identical religion. (4 marks)

Part Five: Student-Choice

Select either Option A or Option B and complete the associated tasks. Use reliable sources and attach additional pages if you need more room. (16 marks).

Option A: Local Indigenous Teaching or Symbol

Using reliable and respectful sources, preferably Indigenous-authored where possible, research one Indigenous teaching, sacred symbol, or ceremonial object. Then respond to the following items:

1. Identify the teaching, symbol, or object you selected and the nation or community connected to it, if known. (2 marks)

2. Describe what it means or how it is used in sufficient detail. (4 marks)

3. Explain what values or beliefs it communicates. (4 marks)

4. Explain one respectful practice a non-Indigenous student should follow when learning about it. (3 marks)

5. Provide a bibliography of at least two sources using proper format. (3 marks)

Option B: Creation Story or Artwork Analysis

Using a creation story, artwork, song, or public monument connected to Indigenous spirituality, respond to the following items as you conduct your analysis:

1. Identify the story or artwork you selected and where you found it. (2 marks)

2. Summarize the main spiritual ideas shown in it. (4 marks)

3. Explain how the work connects identity, memory, land, or community. (4 marks)

4. Describe one reason careful interpretation matters when outsiders study Indigenous materials. (3 marks)

5. Provide a bibliography of at least two sources using proper format. (3 marks)

End of Assignment Booklet 2

After you have completed all items, submit your work according to your course instructions.